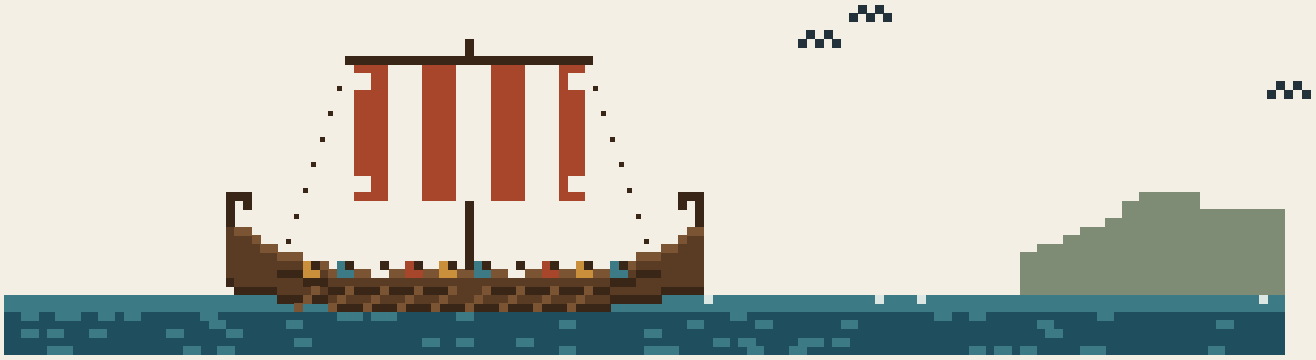
OAR AND EMBER

10 / Balance Sheet

Every tuning number in one place: time, food, fuel, cargo, ships, combat, perception, people, buildings, the ideal progression and the homestead threat schedule.



Numbers drift when they live in seven books. This book is the single source. The tables here are exported as `balance.json`, which the game reads; nothing is hard-coded.

HOW TO USE THIS SET

Change a number here first, then regenerate `balance.json`, then record the change and its reason in the decision log. Other books may quote these values for readability but this book wins any disagreement. All values are starting points for tuning after the user's playtests.

Starting values, not tested balance. Units: game hours and days, real seconds, tiles of 24 px, ticks at 60 Hz, ration-days (rd) of food, loads of fuel and hay, lots of cargo, ounces (oz) of silver.

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01 / How to use this sheet

One table per concern. Every table has a stable name that becomes a key in `balance.json`.

- The export takes each table under a level-two heading and writes it as an array of rows keyed by the column names.
- Code reads values by key (for example `balance.combat.weapons[SPEAR].windup`); content refers to keys, never to literal numbers.
- Tests in Book 2 check that the game's behaviour matches these tables: frame data, travel times, spoilage, food runway, ship stats.
- Changing a value that a test asserts requires changing the test in the same commit, with a decision-log entry.

02 / Time and travel

Clock

Key	Value	Notes
secondsPerHour	50	Real seconds per game hour on foot
dayStart	06:00	Waking time
dayEnd	02:00	Collapse if still awake
activeDayMinutes	16.7	Real minutes from 06:00 to 02:00
sleepAfter	18:00	Earliest time a bed ends the day
collapsePenalty	Wake 08:00, stamina max -30 for the day	
dayLengthOption	0.75 to 1.5	Multiplier on secondsPerHour
watchHours	6	Morning, Day, Evening, Night
seaWatchAnimSeconds	4	Real seconds per watch on the sea map

Daylight

Season	Light from	Dark from
Spring	06:30	20:00
Summer	04:30	23:00
Autumn	07:00	19:00
Winter	08:30	16:00

Tide

Key	Value	Notes
alternation	Flood and ebb each watch	Low water at the end of each ebb watch
phaseShift	1 watch every 3 days	
springTideDays	1, 2, 3 and 16, 17, 18 of each season	
tidalGroundWindow	3 game hours around low water	2.5 real minutes
springLowExtra	Causeways and deep caves open only on spring tide days	

Movement on foot (tiles per second)

Mode	Speed	Notes
Sneak	1.75	Noise x0.25
Walk	3.5	Default
Run	6.0	Drains 5 stamina per second only while in combat
Carry	1.8	Lot or person; attacks disabled
Charge (heavy)	1.5	While holding a heavy
Climb	1.0	On marked climbing routes

Sea travel

Key	Value
watchesFormula	baseWatches x 3 / effectiveSpeed
windFactorRunning	1.2
windFactorBroadReach	1.0
windFactorBeam	0.8
windFactorCloseHauled	0.5
windFactorAgainst	0 (row)
rowingFactor	oarSpeed x rowersPresent / rowingCrew x 0.8
storesPerPersonPerWatch	0.25 rd
forecastAccuracy	0.8

Routes (base watches at speed 3)

Route	Base watches	Exposure	Notes
Skarvholm to Carrick	2	2	
Skarvholm to Saltvik	3	2	
Skarvholm to Kilbrecc	3	2	
Skarvholm to Crowwick	2	1	
Skarvholm to the Cauldron	1	3	Tide gate: slack only
Cauldron to Glen Arra	1	2	Saves about two watches
Crowwick to Glen Arra	2	1	
Crowwick to Inis Rón	2	1	
Carrick to Kilbrecc	1	1	Coastal
Kilbrecc to Dún Fiach	2	1	Coastal
Carrick to Saltvik	2	1	Coastal
Saltvik to Crowwick	2	2	
Skarvholm to Blue Men's Sound	3	3	Winter closed
Blue Men's Sound to Kaldness	3	3	Winter closed

03 / Food, fuel and seasons

Consumption

Key	Value
foodPerPersonPerDay	1 rd (residents, player, hostages)
rationFull	1.0: no penalty
rationShort	0.75: morale -1 band per 5 days, healing -25%
rationHungry	0.5: morale -1 band per 3 days, healing -50%, work -20%
rationStarving	0: sickness risk +10% per day, death risk after 5 days

Food items

Item	Food value	Keeps	Notes
Grain lot	50 rd	1 year in a storehouse; loses 10% per season without	One cargo slot
Fresh fish	1 rd per fish	2 days	
Dried fish	0.8 of fresh	1 season	Racks, 3 dry days
Smoked fish or meat	0.9 of fresh	2 seasons	Smoke-house, 1 day, 1 fuel per 20 rd
Salted fish or meat	1.0 of fresh	1 year	1 salt lot per 60 rd
Preserved lot	40 rd	As its method	One cargo slot
Eggs	4 rd per climb	5 days	Spring days 10 to 40
Milk and cheese	See livestock	Cheese 1 season	

Gathering and fishing (per worker-day at skill 2)

Source	Spring	Summer	Autumn	Winter
Fishing from shore	3	4	3	1 (calm days only)
Fishing from the boat (2 crew)	5	6	4	0
Shellfish and seaweed	2 per low-tide window	2	2	1
Driftwood	1 load per search	1	2 after storms	3 after storms

Barley and kale

Key	Value
skarvholmPlots	4 (6 after clearing; 2 more worker-days each)
seedPerPlot	25 rd of grain
sowWindow	Spring days 1 to 25; -4% yield per day late after day 20
sowLabour	2 worker-days per plot
weedLabour	1 worker-day per plot in summer; unweeded -30%

Key	Value
harvestWindow	Autumn days 61 to 75
harvestLabour	3 worker-days per plot
yieldPerPlot	150 rd (3 grain lots); bad summer -30%
overripe	-50% after day 80; lost after day 90
kaleGarden	1 rd per day in summer and autumn

Livestock

Animal	Milk per day	Slaughter	Winter needs	Notes
Cow	1.5 spring and summer, 0.75 autumn, 0 winter	80 rd	0.15 hay per day and a byre	Without byre: condition falls, death after 15 days
Sheep	0.25 summer	15 rd	0.03 hay per day	Graze machair; 1 wool lot per 6 sheep at shearing
Starting flock	6 half-wild sheep on Skarvholm			

Fuel and hay

Key	Value
peatCut	5 loads per worker-day, spring and summer
peatDry	20 dry days before use
houseFuelPerDay	Summer 0.2, spring and autumn 0.5, winter 1.0
forgeFuel	1 load per working day
coldEffect	No fuel in a winter house: vitality max -10, sickness +5% per day, healing -50%
hayCut	3 loads per worker-day, summer days 31 to 60; needs 3 dry days

Sickness

Condition	Daily risk per resident
Baseline	0.2%
Autumn	+0.5%
Winter	+1%
Cold	+5%
Hungry	+3%
Wounded	+2%
Crowded (over 10 in one house)	+1%
With a healer caring	x0.5

Winter preparation formula

```
food needed = 30 days x mouths + 25% reserve
fuel needed = 30 x heated houses x 1.0 + smoke-house and forge use
hay needed = 30 x (cows x 0.15 + sheep x 0.03)
Example, day 90 with 15 mouths, 2 houses, 3 cows, 12 sheep:
food 563 rd fuel 75 loads hay 25 loads
```

04 / Cargo, trade and silver

Cargo values (oz of silver at a fair market)

Lot or item	Value	Slots
Grain lot	2	1
Preserved fish or meat lot	2	1
Salt lot	3	1
Iron lot	6	1
Timber lot	2	1
Tar lot	3	1
Wool lot	3	1
Cloth lot	8	1
Dye lot	6	1
Hides lot	4	1
Silver lot (hacksilver)	20	1
Church plate	30	1
Wine lot	12	1
Cow	5	2 (pen)
Sheep (pen of 3)	3	2
Amber necklace	6	0
Silver arm-ring	12	0

Price modifiers

Condition	Effect
Recognised stolen goods at an honest buyer	-30% and a `SAIL_SEEN`
Sold quietly through Ottar	-20% cut
Lúnasa fair	+10% sale prices
Local scarcity or glut	+50% or -50%
Faction hostile	No trade

Weapons, armour and tools (buy price)

Item	Price	Notes
Spear	2	
Shield	1	

Item	Price	Notes
Axe	3	
Seax	2	
Bow and arrows	3	
Helmet	10	
Mail shirt	40	
Sword	24	Not forgeable on Skarvholm
Dane axe	12	
Tool head (axe, adze, sickle, spade)	1	
Fishing net	2	

Wages, debts and payments

Key	Value
hiredOarsman	1 oz per voyage-day plus one share
sellsword	3 oz per day
kolbeinnDebt	30 oz
asaDebt	40 oz
ransomDonnchad	60 oz
ransomOrdinary	15 oz
carrickTribute	20 oz (the hidden silver lot)
ormTribute	One tenth of all plunder plus one hostage
shareSystem	Plunder split: household 60%, crew shares 40% (affects Gain regard)

05 / Ship statistics and costs

Hulls

Hull	Length tiles	Oars	Berths	Rowing crew	Cargo	Draft	Sea	Oar	Sail	Integrity	Slots
T1 Coastal boat	7	6	8	4	4	Shallow	2	2	3	100	3
T2 Karvi	12	16	18	10	10	Shallow	3	3	4	180	5
T3a Snekkja	18	26	30	16	8	Medium	3	5	4	240	6
T3b Knarr	13	4	10	4	24	Deep	5	1	4	260	5

Hull costs

Hull	Buy	Build materials	Build labour
T2 Karvi	160 oz	14 timber, 4 iron, 3 tar, 2 cloth	40 worker-days, boatwright skill 3
T3a Snekkja	420 oz	26 timber, 8 iron, 5 tar, 4 cloth	90 worker-days, boatwright skill 4
T3b Knarr	320 oz	22 timber, 6 iron, 5 tar, 4 cloth	70 worker-days, boatwright skill 4

Fittings

Fitting	Cost	Self-built	Effect	Drawback
Extended hold	12 oz	1 timber, 1 iron, 3 worker-days	Cargo +2 (+1 on T1)	Oar -1; rowing crew +1
Raised bow platform	10 oz	2 timber, 2 worker-days	Boarding defence +20%; archers +3 tiles	Cargo -1
Shield rack	4 oz	1 timber	Missile hits -40% with shields up; intimidation +1	Identification +0.2
Grapnels and planks	8 oz	2 iron	Grapple contest +25%	Cargo -1
Awning and stores	8 oz	2 cloth	Stores +4 days; light wounds heal at sea	Cargo -1
Bailing station	5 oz	1 timber	Storm and hull damage -25%	Cargo -1
Towing gear	4 oz	1 timber	Tow a boat for +2 cargo	Speed -1 while towing
Better sail and rigging	30 oz	3 cloth, 1 tar	Sail +1; close-hauled factor 0.65	Wear +50% without a shipwright
Carved beast-head	12 oz	4 worker-days, carving skill 3	Intimidation +1	Offends land-spirits and locals if not unshipped
Gilt weather-vane	40 oz	1 silver lot	Trade prices +5%; forecast 0.9	Identification +0.3

Refits, wear and repair

Key	Value
shallowDraft	20 oz or 2 timber and 4 worker-days; sea -1, cargo -1
doubledStrakes	30 oz or 3 timber, 1 iron, 6 worker-days; integrity +30%, oar -1
recaulk	1 tar, 2 worker-days; wear to 0
wearPerWatchAtSea	1
wearPerBattle	5
wearLeak	At 50: oar -1
wearSailRisk	At 80: 10% per storm watch of sail damage
maintenance	Shipwright removes 10 wear per worker-day
repair	1 timber per 25 integrity; 1 worker-day per 20
stormDamage	5 x storm strength x exposure / seaworthiness per watch

06 / Combat timings

Weapons (ticks at 60 Hz)

Weapon	Reach tiles	Combo	Windup	Active	Recovery	Chain window	Damage	vs shield	Stamina
Spear	1.7	2	14	6	16	10	22	8	14
Axe	1.1	3	16	6	20	10	26	22	18
Sword	1.25	3	11	5	13	9	22	10	12
Seax	0.75	3	8	4	9	8	14	4	8
Dane axe	1.4	2	24	7	26	12	40	35	26
Bow	8.3	1	30 draw	-	20	-	18	6	10
Thrown spear	5	1	18	-	22	-	24	12	16

Charged heavy

Key	Value
level1At	18 ticks held: damage x1.5, vs shield x1.5, tell: glint
level2At	45 ticks held: damage x2.0, guard break (unblockable, parryable), tell: flash and sound
maxHold	90 ticks, then auto-release
releaseRecovery	Weapon recovery + 10 ticks
staminaCost	Weapon stamina x1.5 (L1), x2.0 (L2)

Defence

Key	Value
parryStartup	2 ticks
parryWindow	8 ticks (option: up to 12)
parryRecoveryOnMiss	18 ticks
parryCost	8 stamina, refunded on success
parryStagger	Attacker staggered 36 ticks; riposte damage x1.5
blockArc	120 degrees front
blockCost	0.6 x the attack's shield damage
guardBreak	Stamina empty while blocking: 40 ticks broken
dodge	20 stamina; 20 ticks; invulnerable ticks 4 to 13; 1.5 tiles
shove	12 stamina; breaks block; target staggered 20 ticks
turnLock	Facing locked from windup start to recovery end

Vitality, stamina and armour

Key	Value
vitality	100 for the steerer and adult residents
stamina	100; regenerates 25 per second after 36 ticks without spending; half while blocking
padded	-10% all damage
mail	-30% cut, -15% thrust and missiles
helmet	Head-blow critical chance halved
bloodiedBelow	50% vitality
downedBleedOut	45 seconds unless carried or treated
secondWind	5 seconds; adjacent ally lifts the steerer to 25 vitality; once per scene
dismemberChance	35% on killing blows from heavy axe, Dane axe or sword
finisherHold	24 ticks
hitStop	3 ticks

07 / Enemies, wildlife and perception

Archetypes

Archetype	Vitality	Armour	Weapons	Behaviour
Civilian (farmer, keeper, trader)	60	None	Tool or seax	Flees, hides, pleads; fights if cornered
Monk	50	None	None	Flees to tower or church; claims sanctuary
Guard	100	Padded	Spear and shield	Holds posts, raises alarm
Warrior	110	Padded, sometimes mail	Axe or sword and shield	Fights in line, flanks
Raider (Crowwick)	100	Padded	Axe, spear	Aggressive, loots, rarely surrenders
Archer	80	None	Bow, seax	Keeps distance, falls back
Huscarl (Orm)	130	Mail, helmet	Sword or Dane axe	Disciplined, holds formation
Outlaw	90	None	Mixed	Ambushes, flees when hurt
Draugr	160	Resists stagger	Grip and blows	Slow, relentless at night; returns until its anchor is resolved
Wolf	50	None	Bite	Packs of 3 to 5; circles; flees at half pack lost
Boar	120	Hide	Charge	Charges when cornered; drops 40 rd of meat
Each-uisce	300	Supernatural	Drag into water	Avoid or bind; violence only drives it off

Perception (tiles)

Key	Value
sightDay	15
sightDusk	9

Key	Value
sightNightUnlit	5
sightInLight	Full day range inside a light radius
fogFactor	0.5
heightBonus	x1.5 from watch posts and hilltops
sightCone	110 degrees
noiseSneak	0.5
noiseWalk	2
noiseRun	5
noiseCombat	10
noiseShout	14
noiseHorn	60
noiseDog	20 (dogs hear at 20 and bark)
surfaceShingle	Noise x1.5
surfaceSand	Noise x0.7
memorySeconds	20
torchLightRadius	4 tiles

Cohesion and surrender

Key	Value
groupCohesionStart	100
allyKilled	-20
allyDowned	-10
leaderKilled	-15
outnumberedTwoToOne	-10 per 10 seconds
surrenderBelow	30
fleeBelow	20
noQuarterAfter	2 known `SURRENDERED_KILLED` deeds by the household

Occupied Skarvholm garrison (late game)

Post	Strength	Notes
Broch fort	Kolgrím the Burner and 9 huscarls, 3 dogs	Captives held inside; dogs hear with three times the normal noise radius
Barracks (old longhouse)	12 raiders	Asleep at night unless the horn sounds
Watch cairn on Rook Hill	2, a horn and a beacon	If the horn sounds and they live 60 s more, they light the beacon: Orm's fleet sails 5 days early
Hermit's cell	1 sentry at night	Sees down into Gull Geo
Naust Cove ships	2 ships, 6 on watch	Crews join a fight 120 s after the horn; ships can be burned
The dig at the cairn	Gróa, 4 guards, 6 conscripted diggers	Diggers are civilians

Post	Strength	Notes
Patrol	3	One loop every 240 s
Stakes in the drowned strand	Wreck Strand	A hull landing there at high tide takes 20 integrity damage

Hostility and evidence

Key	Value
hostileOnSightAt	Faction regard -60 or a known `CIVILIAN_KILLED` deed
waryAt	Faction regard -30
identificationLinkThreshold	0.5
bodyFoundNearSettlement	Next morning
bodyFoundWilderness	3 to 10 days
offshoreFishermanChance	25% per daytime raid on a coast
droppedGearPoints	0.3 per recognisable item

08 / People, skills and wounds

Skills

Key	Value
levels	0 to 5
xpPerWorkerDay	1 in the skill used
xpToLevel	10 for 2, 30 for 3, 60 for 4, 100 for 5 (cumulative)
outputMultiplier	0.6 + 0.15 x level (0.6 at 0, 1.35 at 5)
playerTimingBonus	Up to +25% task output for good timing

Regard deltas by deed (valence per value point)

Deed	Gain	Mercy	Glory	Kin	Faith	Word
`THEFT`	+2	+1	-1	0	0	0
`THREAT`	+2	-1	+1	0	0	0
`TRIBUTE_TAKEN`	+2	+1	-1	0	0	0
`FAIR_TRADE`	+1	+1	-1	0	0	+2
`KILLING`	0	-2	+2	0	0	0
`CIVILIAN_KILLED`	0	-4	-1	0	-1	-1
`SURRENDERED_KILLED`	0	-4	-1	0	0	-3
`SPARED`	0	+3	-1	0	0	+1
`BURNING`	-1	-3	+1	0	0	0
`SEED_TAKEN`	+1	-2	0	0	0	0
`SEED_LEFT`	-1	+2	0	0	0	0
`SACRED_TAKEN`	+2	0	+1	0	-4 (same faith)	0

Deed	Gain	Mercy	Glory	Kin	Faith	Word
SACRILEGE	0	-1	0	0	-3 (same faith)	0
RESCUE	-1	+3	0	+1	0	0
HOSTAGE_TAKEN	+1	-1	0	0	0	0
PROMISE_KEPT	0	0	0	0	0	+3
PROMISE_BROKEN	0	0	0	0	0	-4
Resident left behind	0	-1	0	-4	0	-1
Crew member died	0	0	0	-2	0	0
Retreat with everyone alive	0	+1	-2	+2	0	0

`delta = sum(weight x valence x witness)`, clamped to -15 and +15 per deed; witness factor 1.0 present, 0.6 told by a trusted tie, 0.3 rumour. Kári and any resident with Glory 3 and no Mercy treat `CIVILIAN_KILLED` Glory as +1.

Regard bands

Band	From
Devoted	70
Loyal	40
Content	10
Uneasy	-10
Resentful	-40
Estranged	below -40

Wounds

Severity	Recovery	Effect
Light	2 days	-10 vitality max
Serious	6 days	Cannot fight; half work
Grave	14 days	Bed-bound; needs care; 10% death risk without care
Maimed	Permanent	A trait (lost eye, stiff hand) with a skill penalty

09 / Buildings, tools and crafting

Buildings

Building	Footprint tiles	Materials	Worker-days	Capability
Sail shelter in the broch	Broch	Salvaged sail	1	Shelter for 6
Longhouse	16 x 6	10 timber, 1 iron	12	Housing 10; hearth; morale +1
Second house	14 x 6	8 timber, 1 iron	10	Housing 8
Boatshed (naust)	14 x 5	6 timber	8	Ship maintenance, winter lay-up, refits, hull building
Forge	6 x 5	1 timber, 1 iron, stone	4	Smithing
Drying racks	8 x 5	2 timber	2	Dry fish
Smoke-house	6 x 5	3 timber	4	Smoke fish and meat
Storehouse	8 x 4	5 timber, 1 iron	6	No grain loss; capacity 40 lots
Byre	10 x 5	5 timber	6	Winter shelter for 6 cattle
Watch cairn	Rook Hill	Stone	4	One watch of warning when manned
Workshop	6 x 5	3 timber	4	Carpentry, tools, shields
Shrine, cross or hammer-post	4 x 3	1 timber	2	Faith morale for those it suits
Palisade (mainland)	Per 2 tiles	1 timber	1	Defence
Gate and watch platform	4 x 2	3 timber, 1 iron	4	Defence, sight x1.5
removalRefund		50% of materials		

Smithing (per iron lot at the forge)

Product	Yield	Labour	Skill
Tool heads	4	1 worker-day	1
Spearheads	6	1 worker-day	1
Axe heads	2	1 worker-day	2
Boat rivets	30	1 worker-day	1
Helmet	1 (needs 1 lot)	3 worker-days	3
Mail shirt	1 (needs 4 lots)	20 worker-days	4
Sword	1 (needs 2 lots)	10 worker-days	5, mainland forge only

Carpentry

Product	Materials	Labour
Shield	1 timber per 3, hides	1 worker-day per 3
Spear shafts	1 timber per 6	0.5 worker-day

Product	Materials	Labour
Fishing net	1 wool lot per 2	1 worker-day
Hull patch (Chapter 1)	4 boards, 30 rivets	2 worker-days

10 / Target progression for a good player

An idealised path for a capable player who plans well. It sets balance targets; it is not a script. Most players will be behind it in places and ahead in others.

Day	Milestone	Residents	Voyages (raids)	Tools and weapons	Ship	Buildings	Food and stores
6	Chapter 1 done; boat launched	4	0	Wreck kit: 2 axes, Runa's tools, 2 spears, 2 shields, Bran's axe, Thorkel's sword (or buried), knives, a line	T1, 1 fitting	Sail shelter, fire	8 to 10 days runway
15	First raid home	5 (Eithne)	1 (1)	+1 to 2 iron lots	T1, 1 fitting	Forge marked out	30 days runway
30	Two raids and one trade; plots sown	6 to 8 (Kolbeinn, Asa)	3 (2)	Axes 3, adze, 2 sickles, 2 spades, 2 nets; spears for all, 5 shields, 2 axes, 1 sword, 1 helmet	T1, 2 fittings	Forge, racks, longhouse framed; 30 peat loads drying	150 rd stored; 25 days runway
45	The Followers arrive	12 to 13	5 (3)	Spears and shields for all fighters	T1, 3 fittings	Longhouse done, smoke-house; hay cutting begins	200 rd; runway 15 days (more mouths)
60	End of Chapter 3; Nessa joined	13	7 (4)	3 helmets, 2 bows	First refit; 8 timber stockpiled for the karvi	Second house started, storehouse, byre, watch cairn; 2 cows, 8 sheep	300 rd; 50 dry peat
75	Harvest in	13 to 14	8 (5)		Karvi bought or keel laid	All four plots harvested	+600 rd from barley
90	Winter ready	14	9 (6)	1 to 2 mail shirts, 4 helmets	Karvi acquired or 60% built; laid up in the boatshed	2 houses, store, byre, smoke-house, racks, forge, workshop, shrine	600 rd (40 days), 75 fuel, 25 hay
120	Winter survived	14 to 15	9		Karvi launched if built	Repairs done	No deaths from cold or hunger; Yule feast held
150	First answer settled or beaten	15 to 16	12 (8)	All fighters helmeted; 3 mail	Second hull planned	Defences on Skarvholm	30 days runway
180	Council commits to a site	16	14		Consort acquired	Mainland site scouted on foot	Island failing: water hauled

Day	Milestone	Residents	Voyages (raids)	Tools and weapons	Ship	Buildings	Food and stores
210	Mainland home defensible	16	17	Mainland forge: swords possible	Two ships	M2: hall, palisade, gate, boatshed	4 hinterland places known
240	Council ends; Orm holds Skarvholm	16	19		T3 hull	M2 complete	4 allies committed, 1 conditional; 2 of 3 keys in hand or in reach
250	The Return: the Cup recovered	16	20 (the Return)		Flagship, consort, an allied ship	Beacon unlit; Orm's two ships burned	Compact renewed at Inis Rón
270	Finale	16 plus allies	21				

Gate checks against this table

- Build 2 (Stage 20): a scripted good-player run reaches the day-30 row within 10%.
- Stage 25: a household at the day-90 row survives winter with no deaths from cold or hunger; at half the stores it fails visibly, with warnings from day 70.
- Autoplay: the merciful policy reaches day 90 within 15% of the brutal policy's wealth and ahead of it on allies.

11 / Homestead threat schedule

A rough schedule of what reaches the home. Most threats are conditional on the player's deeds and preparation; each has a warning and a counter.

Year 1 on Skarvholm

Days	Threat	Condition	Warning	Scale	Counter
3 to 6	Wreck-scavengers return at night	Not dealt with in Chapter 1	Lights in Seal Cave	3	Watch, fight, bargain
8 to 14	First storm	Always	Sky and swell a day ahead	Camp damage	Secure the sail roof; driftwood after
18 to 28	Crowwick skiff lands at Gull Geo to steal	Ulf's interest or 50%	Unknown sail at dusk from Rook Hill	4 to 5	A watcher at the cell; dogs later
From 20	Thorkel's draugr on Wreck Strand at low-tide nights	No rites given	Wet footprints to the door	1, escalating weekly	Rites; the promise he wants
25 to 40	Hollow Cairn disturbances	Cairn looted or insulted	Tools moved, milk soured	Losses	An offering; returning what was taken
35 to 55	Ulf's visit demanding a share	Household wealth over 40 oz or Oddi's debt	His sail two days before	12 to 15 men	Pay, bargain, fight, or ally
50 to 60	Storm surge reaches the broch	Always	Spring tide forecast	Flooded stores if low	Raise stores; storehouse
61 to 90	Autumn storms (up to three) and fever	Always	Forecasts; coughs	Damage; sickness	Fuel, care, roofs

Days	Threat	Condition	Warning	Scale	Counter
70 to 85	Asgrim's first visit	Always	Grey sails at anchor	3 ships, demand only	Answer or delay
86 to 94	The Cailleach's washing	Always	Hag-cloud over the Cauldron	Severe storm	Ship in the boatshed; roofs
91	Samhain night	Always	The dead and hill-folk walk	Supernatural	Stay in, keep the fires, or bargain
91 to 120	Cold, hunger, long nights	Preparation	Morning report from day 70	Deaths if unprepared	Winter stores
100 to 115	Desperate men in a calm window	SEED_TAKEN or Ardcarn hungry	A small boat seen at dusk	4 to 6	Watch, defend, feed them
105	Yule	Always	Feast	The draugr strongest if unresolved	Rites; the feast's morale
118 to 120	Asgrim returns for an answer	Always	Sails at Imbolc	Demand	Pay, refuse, deceive

Year 2 and the mainland

Days	Threat	Condition	Warning	Scale	Counter
121 to 150	The coast's answer (Book 6 scenario 8)	Ledger	Precursors 5 days ahead	Raid, arson, interdict or envoy	Settle or defend
130 to 160	Orm's scout ship probes	Always	A grey sail off Rook Hill	1 ship	Hide strength or show it
About 140	Storm-tide slumps Naust Cove	Always	Spring tide forecast	Landing lost	Move the boat; new slip
150 to 180	The spring fails at every spring tide; refugees	Always	Brackish water	Thirst, crowding	Haul water; shelter plans
181 to 240	Hostile guards on sight in wronged territory	Ledger	Region map shows hostile ground	Patrols of 3 to 6	Avoid, sneak, settle
181 to 240	Wolves at night, worst in winter	Wilderness	Howls, tracks	Packs of 3 to 5	Fires, fences, hunting
181 to 240	Outlaws on roads	Wilderness	Signs of a camp	4 to 8	Fight, pay, recruit
About 200	Neighbours test the new home: cattle lifted	Always	Cattle restless at night	6 to 10	Watch, return in kind, negotiate
About 220	Ulf's attack on the mainland home	Ulf hostile	His raven sail	25	Defences, allies
About 228	Orm takes Skarvholm as a forward base	Always; outpost residents are taken captive	Smoke over the island, seen from the mainland	2 ships, about 40	Abandon, reinforce, or accept; rescue in the Return
241 to 252	The Return to Skarvholm (required)	Always	The Keepers' revelation and scouting reports	Garrison in section 07	Book 6 scenario 9; section 13; checkpoint before landing; one retry before day 255

Days	Threat	Condition	Warning	Scale	Counter
256 to 270	Orm's fleet and the finale	Always	The washer at the ford	6 to 10 ships; two fewer if the Naust ships were burned; 5 days earlier if the beacon was lit	Everything prepared

12 / Guard rails

Rules that must stay true whatever the numbers become.

- A delegated, sensibly managed home survives a season without player input; the player's own work is always a bonus.
- Winter is survivable by a player who heeds the morning report from day 70.
- No approach to raiding dominates every measure; brutality pays quickly and costs later.
- Combat tells are always readable: at least 6 ticks between a tell and active frames.
- First departure within 45 to 60 minutes; combat inside 25.
- Supernatural events about one voyage in three or four; signs more often than encounters.
- No resource can go below zero, and every shortage is explained in words.

13 / The Return to Skarvholm

Numbers for the late-game expedition (Book 6 scenario 9, Book 9 sections 08 and 09). It should be hostile and difficult.

Timers and rules

Key	Value
ormTakesSkarvholm	About day 228
returnWindow	Days 241 to 252; one retry before day 255
hornToReinforcement	360 s real after the horn
naustCrewsJoin	120 s after the horn
beaconDelay	60 s after the horn, if the cairn watch lives
patrolLoop	240 s
falseHornDelay	60 s (Thrand's signals)
surgeTidalGround	180 s after the Cup is lifted
surgeSealCavePassage	240 s
surgeCauseway	300 s
surgeStrand	480 s
liesToSeal	3; the Door reopens at the next spring tide
wardenPerLie	One cairn warden per lie

Key	Value
retryGarrison	+50% fighters; dogs at the cell
holmgangaRule	Duel on the Skerry at low tide; three shields each; the loser's side yields the night
kolgrimFairDefeat	Garrison cohesion -30 for the night
firstAttemptTarget	Good-player autoplay recovers the Cup on the first attempt in no more than 60% of seeds

Late-game enemies

Archetype	Vitality	Armour	Weapons	Behaviour
Kolgrím the Burner	160	Mail, helmet	Dane axe, torch	Aggressive; loves fire; accepts a public challenge
Garrison huscarl	130	Mail, helmet	Sword or spear and shield	Disciplined; holds the palisade
Gróa	70	None	Sea-light	Pulls targets within 6 tiles towards water at 1 tile per second; flees when hurt
Drowned digger	90	Resists stagger	Grip	Slow; banished by daylight or rites, not killed
Cairn warden	200	Cannot be killed	Blows that knock down	Driven back for 20 s by heavy blows; leaves when the truths are complete or the party leaves